

		2026 PSML Division A Championships Coach and Representative Notes
1		There will be two CJ's, and they will alternate between the start and turn ends.
2		The 15 m mark will be a piece of blue tape on the deck, extending into the water and will be watched by the CJ at the turn end.
3		All starts will take place at the start end by the tents, furthest from the pool house.
4		Two starters will alternate between boys and girls events. The off starter will be taking order refinish. The turn end CJ will be taking order of finish for 25 m events.
5		25 m finishes will be at the turn end closest to the pool house, and timers will move to the 25 m events clockwise around the pool. They will return counterclockwise.
6		Only four stroke and turn judges will be on deck at a time officiating. The other two will be off or, during relays, performing as take-off judges.
7		There will be a 10 minute break after breaststroke and before backstroke. There will also be a 10 minute break after IMs and before relays.
8		The continuous warm-up and warm-down pool is for 13 and older swimmers and not to be abused. No diving, feet first entry only from the pool house side of the deck. Swimming only, no playing
9		False starts are dual confirmed by the starter and referee.
10		Take-off violations are dual confirmed by two judges, one watching lanes 1-6 and the other watching lanes 6-1. They watch the feet leave the edge and then look for the incoming swimmer to have touched. Violations will be marked on a take-off slip, and no hands will be raised if a violation is observed.
11		No video will be considered as evidence in discussing DQs. All complaints regarding DQs must come from the team representative only.
12		During the swims in the start, there will be no music.

**2026 PSML Division A Championships
Rule Changes and Important Notes**

1		The starter used to have sole jurisdiction over the starting position; now it is the starter or stroke and turn. (Rule 101.1.2.E). (typically observed in backstroke) * A swimmer shall be disqualified for an illegal starting position at the start if the swimmer moves from a legal starting position to an illegal starting position immediately prior to or after the “take your marks” command provided that the illegal starting position exists when the signal to start the race is given. * In the backstroke, the toes cannot be curled over the gutter (Adelphi has no gutter). Toes may be above the water but not above the pool edge. * If a swimmer’s feet are in a legal starting position and then move to an illegal position and the feet are still illegal at the start, the S&T or starter has jurisdiction to disqualify. * If the swimmer immediately assumes an illegal position, the S&T or starter should instruct the swimmer to correct it. * If the feet are in an illegal position and the swimmer is allowed to continue without correction and the race is started, no DQ will be issued.
2		No Technical Suits shall be worn by any 12 & Under athlete in competition at any sanctioned, approved or observed meet. If the swimmer is 12&U and the suit has a QR code, then look for a green box with a checkmark.
3		Swimmers must remain and finish the race in the same lane in which they started. (Article 102.21.5)
4		Swimmers may be submerged while finishing the butterfly and freestyle. (101.3, 101.4, 101.5) * Once some part of the head of the swimmer has passed the final 5-meter mark, immediately prior to reaching for the finish, the swimmer may be completely submerged. * Must conform to the stroke rules. For example, in backstroke when the swimmer resubmerges to reach for the wall, they may not take a stroke as it is no longer "reaching" (101.4.2, Situations and Resolutions 2025-03-07 #68).
5		Therapeutic elastic tape is no longer prohibited. Buddy taping is limited to two fingers and/or two toes.
6		(PMSL) Towels may be used for backstroke starts only (no forward starts or relay exchanges), one single one layer towel, must be removed after the start (no penalty for not removing), and may not interfere with other swimmers or officials.